

doctrine of James 1st f., that the only ritual (θρησκεία) that is acceptable to the God and Father is that of practical benevolence and a pure heart. So we pass on to the twin gifts of God to man, perfect soundness and endless life. "I came that they may have life and have abundance," said the Johannine Christ, and these are just the two great gifts foreshadowed in Zarathushtra's thought: their splendid comprehensive-ness shows how well he knew ζηλοῦν τὰ χαρίσματα τὰ μείζονα.¹ And like the rest, these gifts are attributes of the Divine. Here, as all through our exposition, we can go to the New Testament to enlarge and explain great truths that Zarathushtra saw "in a mirror, riddewise." To realise the Amshaspand Haurvatat, "Wholeness," or Salvation,² we remember the command, "Be perfect, even as your heavenly Father is perfect." And for its twin, the projection of this perfect soundness, this fullness of life and blessing, into a future which death has no power to mar, we think of the revelation of Him who "only hath immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light,"³ and of the words that tell us how He "created man for incorruption, and made him an image of his own proper being."⁴

I have intentionally spent a little time in expanding the obvious parallels from the Christian Scriptures,

¹ John 10¹⁰, 1 Cor. 12³¹.

² Jackson, in a recent paper (*Amer. Journal of Theol.*, April 1913, p. 198), remarks that Haurvatat "denotes 'wholeness,' 'perfection,' 'saving grace,' and hence 'salvation'" — its etymological cognate, by the way.

³ 1 Tim. 6¹⁶.

⁴ Wisdom 2²³. For ιδιότητος two cursives read αἰδιότητος, "everlastingness."

because the very juxtaposition of the implicit and the explicit may help us to make for ourselves a profitable comparison of the two religions. We cannot praise the older faith more highly than by showing how it contained seed-thoughts that in the light and warmth of Christian enthusiasm might have blossomed into beauty for all the world to admire. There is also another comment that will be in place after nearly every paragraph in the present exposition. We have seen that Judaism and Christianity have developed a series of fundamental ideas which can be recognised centuries before in the obscure phrases of the Gathas. But the difference of setting is so complete that we have not to argue against the perversely ingenious people who write as if there was a complete set of Sacred Books of the East in Aramaic on the shelves of a public library in Nazareth or Capernaum. One cannot, of course, predict what a Jensen or a Drews may say—*quibus est nihil negatum!* But for scholars in general there will, of course, be no thought of dependence in such a sphere as this; and the very fact that there may be such deep-seated affinity in religions which at least in these respects admittedly did not influence one another, may be remembered as a useful caution later on.

Pursuing my general comparative method, I proceed to point out a more recondite affinity than those I have been noticing. I have observed already that the Amshaspands are so markedly within the Divine hypostasis as not to allow the suggestion that Zarathushtra's own thought fell short of monotheism. There is a very real but by no means obvious parallel in the development of Early Christian

theology. For my purpose it does not matter when or how the doctrine of the Trinity emerged as an attempt to explain the mutual relations of Divine Personalities who are central in the New Testament: my point would not be affected if the Trinitarian dogma was the invention of Athanasius. Nor need I stop to define the Catholic doctrine, which I naturally do not suggest to be an exact or even very close parallel to Zarathushtra's idea. Obviously the Iranian sage would never have approved or even understood the Athanasian Creed. For him the doctrine of an incarnation would have associated itself with the unlovely avatars of Aryan mythology, and have suffered discredit from the association, just as it would have been discredited in the eyes of Socrates by the epiphanies of Greek deities. It is very suggestive that the Christian doctrine of Incarnation sprang up on virgin soil.¹ The affinity between the Christian and the pure Zarathushtrian doctrine lies simply in the fact that both systems realise the necessity of recognising a differentiation within the Godhead—that if God is “the white radiance of eternity,” there is also “a rainbow round about the Throne,” which is that same Radiance seen in another way. There are six hues, or more, in Zarathushtra's rainbow, only three in the Christian, but the underlying reason is the same. It is, moreover, only

¹ Perhaps I had better guard myself by observing that I am perfectly aware of arguments that have been urged in favour of foreign influences here. I cannot discuss them in these Lectures, and need only say that they entirely fail to commend themselves to my judgement, which in this matter is altogether free from bias. How anyone could fail to see in Matt. i.-ii. the most intensely Jewish chapters in the New Testament passes my comprehension.